

own profiles. Author section in Bebo also has authors posting excerpts from their books which are reviewed by the community and rated.

The search within Bebo allows you to search for friends inside. There are college / school networks where you can join as student or alumnus. A funny section drew our attention. "What are you doing?" the question went, and just write what you are doing now , what are you



Skins you can use

doing tonight or what you wished you were doing. The most popular quotes (we can't figure out how they did that) got prominent mention. You can mail people using a standard form, though the mail can have a selected skin as well. And people who have Skype IDs can chat with friends from inside Bebo. Friends can write stories for you, and you can put the image of your other half (boyfriend, girlfriend, buddy) and highlight it.

Our experiences with the site were mixed. We had a lot of trouble searching for profiles and stumbled only on a link purely by accident. All the customisation looked easy, but the end result was often not what the owners intended. Most of the profiles we browsed had atrocious designs as widgets were thoughtlessly added. It almost gave one the picture of a skinny donkey being burdened with heavy loads. Owing to the choice of skins, many profiles were not readable. And some members updated animations as their profile picture. Though it sounds cool, sometimes these animations are pretty distracting, especially in the Thumbnail view.

Of all the public profiles we viewed we saw a lot of profiles of teens under the age of 18. This conforms to the result of a survey